

Rafael Campos-Gottardo

McGill University

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EDUCATION

McGill University

M.A. in Political Science

Advisor: Aaron Erlich

Thesis: “The Impact of Political Violence on Levels of Polarization: Evidence from a Natural Experiment”

Montréal, QC

2023 – 2026

University of Michigan

ICPSR Summer Program

Courses: Panel Data and Longitudinal Analysis; Text Analysis and Data Science

Lectures: Matrix Algebra, Calculus, and Probability; Introduction to Python

Ann Arbor, MI

Jul. 2024 – Aug. 2024

Wilfrid Laurier University

B.A. in Political Science *with high distinction*; **Alumni Gold Medal**

Minor in History

Undergraduate MRP: “The Puzzle of Centrist Populism: An analysis of Nayib Bukele in El Salvador”

Waterloo, ON

2019 – 2023

PUBLICATIONS

In Progress

- “Assessing The Comparative Effects of Persuasive Appeals with Partisanship, Built Characteristics, Housing Status and Neighbourhood Environments in Support for New Developments in the 2022 Ontario General Election” with Matthew Arp, Timothy Gravelle, Simon Kiss, Anthony Piscitelli, and Zachary Spicer.
- “Comparing Partisan and Rational Choice Motivations for Supporting Housing Policies.” with Matthew Arp, Timothy Gravelle, Simon Kiss, Anthony Piscitelli, and Zachary Spicer.
- “Exploring the Changing Social Diversity in Small and Mid-sized Canadian Cities, 2001-2021” with Zhixi Zhuang, Feng Hou, and Mariam El Toukhy.
- “Civic Engagement in Rebuilding Ukraine: Observational and Experimental Evidence” with Aaron Erlich & Dietlind Stolle.
- “Casualties Without Concessions? Panel Evidence on Ukrainian Public Opinion and the Limits of War Fatigue” with Aaron Erlich.
- “Confront or Accommodate Russia? An Emerging Geopolitical Cleavage in European Politics” with Dietlind Stolle & Maria Popova.

Reports & Non-Peer Reviewed Publications

- [3] Perrella, A., **Campos-Gottardo, R.**, & Kiss, S. (2026). Housing, Healthcare, and More: Decoding the 2022 Ontario General Election. *The Canadian Political Science Review*, 19(1), 62-67.
- [2] Kiss, S. & **Campos-Gottardo, R.** (2025). Researching Post-Industrial Political Behaviour With The National Occupation Classification In The 2019 and 2021 Canada Election Studies. *LISPOP Reports*.
- [1] **Campos-Gottardo, R.** (2022). Populism, inequality, and Lëvizja Vetëvendosje in Kosovo: Shaping society through populist discourses. *Undergraduate Journal of Politics, Policy, and Society (University of Ottawa)*, 5(1), 56-90.

SOFTWARE

- [1] **Campos-Gottardo, R.** & Kiss, S. (2025). *Occupations Qualtrics Module for Canadian Political Science Surveys*. GitHub repository: <https://github.com/RafaelGottardo/occupations-qualtrics>.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

* Indicates presenting author

- [9] **Campos-Gottardo, R.*** (2026, June). The Impact of Political Violence on Levels of Polarization: Evidence from a Natural Experiment. **Paper presentation:** Canadian Political Science Association, Ottawa, ON.
- [8] Lehecka, N.,* Thomson, B., **Campos-Gottardo, R.,*** & Kiss, S.* (2025, June). Did The Ford Government Suffer Any Electoral Backlash From the Laurentian University Bankruptcy? **Poster presentation:** Canadian Political Science Association, Toronto, ON.
- [7] **Campos-Gottardo, R.,*** Arp, M., Gravelle, T., Kiss, S.,* Piscitelli, A., & Spicer, Z. (authors in alphabetical order) (2025, June). Do appeals to benefits overcome NIMBY-ISM?. **Paper presentation:** Canadian Political Science Association, Toronto, ON.
- [6] Erlich, A.,* Stolle, D., & **Campos-Gottardo, R.** (2024, June). Civic Engagement in Rebuilding Ukraine: Observational and Experimental Evidence. **Paper presentation:** Canadian Political Science Association, Montréal, QC.
- [5] **Campos-Gottardo, R.,*** & Kiss, S.* (2024, June). Social Media Use and Polarization in Ontario: 2018 Case Study. **Paper presentation:** Canadian Political Science Association, Montréal, QC.
- [4] **Campos-Gottardo, R.*** (2024, January). Correlates of Populist Attitudes in Canada: Evidence from the CES. **Paper presentation:** Bell Chair Graduate Student Conference, Ottawa, ON.
- [3] **Campos-Gottardo, R.*** & Perrella, A. (2023, May). The Role of Populist Attitudes on Support for Centrist Populist Candidates: Evidence From El Salvador. **Poster presentation:** Canadian Political Science Association, Toronto, ON.
- [2] **Campos-Gottardo, R.*** (2022, August). Populism and authoritarianism during the COVID-19 pandemic: The case of Nayib Bukele in El Salvador. **Paper presentation:** Congress of the Canadian Association for Latin American and Caribbean Studies, Toronto, ON.
- [1] **Campos-Gottardo, R.***, Jasemi, A., & Gottardo, A. (2022, June). Parenting beliefs about the importance of politics and child qualities: Similarities and differences across borders. **Poster presentation:** Development 2022, Calgary, AB.

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

CSDC - Summer Methods Grant, 2024 (\$3,000)
FRQ-SC Master's Scholarship, 2024 (\$26,667)
Stolle Graduate Award, 2024 (\$2,500)
SSHRC Canada Graduate Scholarship – Master's, 2023 (\$17,500)
Library Research Award – First Prize, Senior Division, 2023 (\$350)
Harry and Lillian Kay Scholarship, 2022 (\$1,000)
Menich Family Co-op Award, 2022 (\$6,300)

RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

Global Migration Institute Toronto Metropolitan University/DiverCity Lab	
Zhixi Zhuang	2026 – present
Université du Québec à Montréal	
Elizabeth Chrun	2025 – present
Centre for the Study of Democratic Citizenship	
Dietlind Stolle	2024 – present
Aaron Erlich	2023 – 2026
Laurier Institute for the Study of Public Opinion and Policy	
Simon Kiss	2022 – present

TEACHING & TEACHING ASSISTANCE

Université de Montréal

CÉCD - Winter Methods School - Topic Modelling in Political Science

January 2026

McGill University

McGill PSSA - Data Analysis Club Instructor

Winter 2026

POLI311 - Introduction to Quantitative Methods

Winter 2024 & (Head TA) 2025

POLI210 - Political Science Research Methods

Fall 2024

CDSI/CSDC - R Summer Camp

August 2024 & 2025

Wilfrid Laurier University

PO479 - Seminar on Research Design - Guest Lecture on Quantitative Causal Inference

February 2025

PO218 - Answering Questions in Political Science

Winter 2023

PO217 - Asking Questions in Political Science

Fall 2022

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fundraising Coordinator, Canadian Landmine Foundation

May – August, 2022

Policy Analyst, Industrial Benefits, FedDev Canada

May – August, 2021

Student Outreach Officer (Citizen Services Branch), Service Canada

June – December, 2020

SKILLS

Technical: R, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Python

Languages: English (Native), French (Professional)